



Dr. Raz Itzhaki
CEO, Orbit Catapult
Lecturer

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To Whom It May Concern,

It is with great enthusiasm that I recommend Shikhi Ibrahimov for admission to your graduate program.

I had the pleasure of mentoring Shikhi during the VISTAR Center of Excellence Program in Entrepreneurship and Technological Innovation, organized together with the Innovation and Digital Development Agency, Azercosmos, Israel Aerospace Industries, and the Holon Institute of Technology.

Over eight weeks, Shikhi worked as a member of the SeaSentry team, which developed a SpaceTech and AI-powered solution for early oil-spill detection, rapid response, and the recovery of spilled oil as a resource. Built around the concept of “Detect. Treat. Recycle.”, the team transformed an initial concept into a structured, presentation-ready project and presented it at Demo Day before mentors, partners, and the wider innovation community.

One of Shikhi’s main strengths is his ability to combine technical thinking with an entrepreneurial approach. He does not simply complete assigned tasks; he tries to understand both the technical and practical sides of a problem, takes an active part in team discussions, and contributes constructively to the solution. During the SeaSentry project, he helped shape the technical direction, supported the research effort, and contributed to preparing the project for presentation.

Shikhi also works well within a team and takes responsibility. He expresses his ideas clearly while listening carefully to teammates and mentors. His interest in technology, AI, and innovation, together with his openness to feedback and readiness to work in different team environments, makes his potential for growth especially noticeable.

I am confident that Shikhi has the intellectual ability, work ethic, and motivation required to succeed in a rigorous graduate program. I recommend him without reservation and believe he will make a meaningful contribution to your academic community and to future technology and innovation initiatives.

Sincerely,

Dr. Raz Itzhaki
CEO, Orbit Catapult
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